

Our Lady of Lourdes Steelstown



Sunday 28th June
13th Sunday Of The Year

A cup of water

Life is busy. Whether we are in school, college, working, or juggling family life with all sorts of other commitments, there is sometimes little time to pause and take stock of things. It can be hard to find time to reflect on how our faith is faring. When we do get a minute to assess things, do we find ourselves wanting? Many of us have the idea that we would like to live better lives, to be more caring, to help those in need. We would like to live up to what Jesus asks of us, if only we had time to do more. This desire to do better is an important element of our Christian journey. But often we imagine that this will require some sort of grand gesture or dramatic change of direction.

If we are paralysed or overwhelmed by what we can't do, Jesus has some good news for us today. A cup of water isn't much, and offering hospitality to a stranger might not seem like a big deal, but that is where Jesus starts. Instructing his twelve disciples, he tells them that anyone who welcomes them or offers them a cup of cold water will be rewarded. What's more, he adds that anyone who welcomes them in fact welcomes Jesus, the one who sent them. Small acts of kindness and hospitality have significance beyond what we might expect. No matter how busy we are, there are opportunities every day to offer a cup of water here, or a helping hand there. All these small things play their part in building up God's kingdom.

Triona Doherty



Parish Schedule for July & August

MASS TIMES:

Saturday: *Vigil Mass*: 6:30pm

**Sunday: 09:00am; 11:00am;
and 12:15pm**

Tuesday - Saturday: 10:00am

CONFESSIONS:

**Saturday: 10:30am-11:30am;
&, 5:45pm - 6:20pm**

THE END OF THE SCHOOL YEAR

Tuesday brings us to the end of the school year. On behalf of our parish communities we thank the teachers and all those who work in our schools for their hard work and dedication during the school year. Entrusting our children and young people to the care of a school places a great responsibility on those involved in education and they are deserving of our support and gratitude.



PRAYER TO END A SCHOOL YEAR

God of wisdom, we thank you for all the gifts you have given us throughout this school year. We praise you for giving us life, for saving us in Christ and for choosing us to be your people.

As we come to the end of this school year we voice our gratitude for the good things you have done in us and we praise you for all who have shared in the work of our school.

We ask you to bless them in your love and peace.

We praise you God through Jesus Christ, our Lord, who lives and reigns forever and ever. Amen

We wish everyone a happy and safe
Summer Holiday.



COUPLES PLANNING TO GET MARRIED If you live in this parish and plan to marry here or in another Catholic Church then you require marriage papers from this parish. You must give at least three months notice of your intention to marry. The following documentation will be required: a recent copy of your Baptism Certificate from the Parish of your Baptism and possibly a letter of freedom. All couples are required to prepare for the Sacrament of Marriage. Accord offers marriage preparation and can be contacted at 71362475 or online at www.accord-ni.co.uk. All couples living in this Parish and planning to marry here or elsewhere in 2026 are please asked to contact the parish office to make arrangements for the completion of the paperwork.

ACCORD DERRY Marriage Preparation Workshops September and November 2026. September 25/26; November 20/21. These courses can be booked online at www.accordni.com. Please note that Accord Derry will NOT be

facilitating courses during October or December 2026.

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

PASSPORT APPLICATIONS Passport Application Forms should be brought to

POPE'S PRAYER INTENTION FOR JUNE

For the values of sports

Let us pray that sports be an instrument of peace, encounter, and dialogue among cultures and nations, and that they promote values such as respect, solidarity, and personal growth.

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OFFICE: Wednesdays to Fridays: 9am to 3pm
Tel: 028 7135 1718
Email: steelstown@derrydiocese.org
culmoreparish@derrydiocese.org

PRIEST: Rev. Declan McGeehan
Email: declan.mcgeehan@derrydiocese.org
Emergency Tel.: 073 5238 7817 (*urgent sick calls only*)

BAPTISMS We welcome into the family of the Church: Barra Young; Sadie Clyde and Cahir Canning.

ANNIVERSARIES Please pray for the repose of the souls of: Catherine Conway; Martin Coyle; Patricia Durnin; Eileen Dowling; Elizabeth McDaid and Martina McClean.

COLLECTION Last Sunday's Pope's Collection amounted to £2,775.00. Thank you for your generosity.

SAFEGUARDING NOTICE If you have any concerns with regard to Safeguarding children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at +447596 500 793 or at dlp@derrydiocese.org. For emergencies please contact PSNI Tel 101 or Social Services Western HSC Trust Tel +442871314090 (Ask for Duty Social Worker).

Additional contact numbers:

Northern Ireland: PSNI Tel 101 or Social Services Western HSC Trust Tel +442871314090 (Ask for Duty Social Worker)

Republic of Ireland: Garda Siochana, Buncrana +353749320540 or Letterkenny HQ +353749167100

TUSLA Family and Child Agency, Buncrana +353749320420 or Letterkenny +353749123672.

SUMMER CONTRIBUTIONS

Many of our parishioners spend the summer weekends in holiday homes and caravans but are anxious to continue supporting the parish during their absence. You can do this by setting up a Standing Order to cover the Sundays you are absent. Please contact the Parish Office for further details.

PARISH NEWSLETTER

There will be no Parish Newsletter during July and August.

7.45AM AND 7PM MASS

There will be no 7.45am Mass or 7pm Monday Mass in this Church during the months of July and August.